Isabella and Mortimer suggested that Edward III was the logical choice to fill the empty throne. The Salic Law, they argued, only prevented women from inheriting the throne; it did not prevent inheritance *through the female line*, as long as the heir himself was male. As Isabella's son, Edward was the closest living male relative of the French royal house.



66.1 Edward III and the Valois

An English king would have needed a much stronger argument (and more swords) to convince the French barons to recognize him, and Edward's bid for the throne failed. Instead, the French nobility chose to recognize Philip of Valois, the Count of Anjou and first cousin of the three dead kings. He was crowned in 1328, the first king of the Valois line; the direct line of Hugh Capet, rulers of France for 340 years, had ended.